

Were you greeted by a long list of errors culminating in something along the lines of ‘django.db.utils.IntegrityError: NOT NULL constraint failed: cms\_article.author\_id’ We caused an error in Django’s integrity, not nice.

What this error boils down to in the end is that we tried to create an article without specifying an author, and the author is not an optional field, unlike the article featured image, which we also did not supply.

The problem now is that we do not have any users right now! Our database is fresh and empty. No problems, we can just create a new user just as we would create a new article. Run the following commands in the shell:

```
• >>> from django.contrib.auth.models import User
• >>> author1 = User()
• >>> author1.first_name = 'Aruna'
• >>> author1.last_name = 'Tank'
• >>> author1.email = 'aruna.tank@mailprovider.com'
• >>> author1.set_password('apassword')
• >>> author1.save()
```

This should work out a lot better than our experiment with creating a new article did. Notice that we used a method to set the password rather than just saying ‘author1.password = “xyz”’, this is because passwords should never be stored directly as raw text in the database. The ‘set\_password’ securely saves the password in the database. If you want to know the exact value it stores in the database, just type ‘author1.password’ in the shell to see this value.

Now that we have an author, let’s try saving that article again. If you didn’t close the shell in between you can still access the partially complete ‘article1’ else you will have to type all of that all over again. Here is what you need to do:

```
• >>> article1.author = author1
• >>> article1.save()
```

This should now work without a hitch. We now have one author and one Article in the database! Go ahead and create more Articles and Authors. It’ll be nice to have a few in place so the next bit is actually meaningful.

## Querying our Database

In this section we learn how to query our database so we can get exactly the data we want. Of course this will only be worthwhile if there already is some data in the database that we can query! And the more data the better.

For this reason we have created a JSON file that comes filled with a collection of Users and Articles. You can import this into the database to